

{tar} command cheat sheet

USAGE

```
$ tar {A|c|d|r|t|u|x}[GnSkUWOmpsMBiajJzZhPIRvwo] [ARG...]
```

DESCRIPTION

GNU tar is an archiving program that allows you to store multiple files in a single file (an archive) and manipulate them. The archive can be a regular file or a device (for example, a tape drive, hence the program's name, which stands for tape archiver), and it can be located on a local or a remote machine.

COMMON OPTIONS

- A** Append archive to the end of another archive.
- c** Create a new archive. Directories are archived recursively, unless the **--no-recursion** option is given.
- d** Find differences between archive and file system.
- delete** Delete provided members from an archive.
- r** Append files to the end of an archive.
- t** List the contents of an archive.
- u** Append files which are newer than the corresponding copy in the archive.
- x** Extract files from an archive.
- ? or --help** Display a short option summary and exit.
- k** Don't replace existing files when extracting.
- O** Extract files to standard output.
- f** filename of the archive.
- v** Verbosely list files processed.
- z** Compress files with **gzip**.
- j** Compress files with **bzip2**.
- J** Compress files with **xz**.
- Z** Compress files with **compress**.
- a** Use archive **suffix/extension** to determine the compression program.
- C** Changes to the specified directory before permitting any operations.
- exclude=FILE** Excludes the when adding to tar archive or extracting from a tar archive.

OPTIONS EXAMPLES

- \$ tar -cf archive.tar file1 file2 fileN** Concatenate files into a single tarball called **archive.tar**.
- \$ tar -tf archive.tar** List the contents of archive without extracting.
- \$ tar -cf archive.tar *** Concatenate all files in a directory into a single tarball called **archive.tar**.
- \$ tar -cf archive.tar *.php** Archive only **php** files.
- \$ tar -xf archive.tar** Extract files from the tar archive file.
- \$ tar -xf archive.tar file1 file2** Extract specific file from an archive.
- \$ tar -tf archive.tar** List the contents of an archive.
- \$ tar -rf archive.tar file_to_append** Append files to an existing archive.
- \$ tar -Af archive.tar archive2.tar** Merge **archive2.tar** into **archive.tar**.
- \$ tar --delete archive.tar file_to_delete** Delete files from an archive.
- \$ tar -df archive.tar file1** Find differences between an archive and file.
- \$ tar -uf archive.tar new_files** Append only new files to the archive.
- \$ tar -xf archive.tar -C directory-path** Extract archive into a specific directory.
- \$ tar -czf archive.tar.gz file1 file2** Create an archive and compress it with **gzip** utility.
- \$ tar -cf archive.tar * --exclude=config.php** Exclude **hello.php** file while creating an archive
- \$ tar -cjf archive.tar.gz file1 file2** Create an archive and compress it with **bzip2** utility.
- tar -zu archive.tar.gz** Append only new files to the **.tar.gz** archive.



\$ tar czf data.tar.gz data ⇒ **create ze file**

\$ tar xzf data.tar.gz ⇒ **extract ze file**